

Asia's largest solar park now in Gujarat

Gujarat's chief minister Narendra Modi has inaugurated a 500MW solar plant in Charanka village of Patan district in Gujarat. The total estimate of the project is in excess of Rs 12 billion and promises to change the landscape of this little known village. Some of the companies that have started constructing solar power plants are Azure Power, GMR Energy and GSPC Pipavav Power Company. The plant would be ready by the end of December 2011.

Spectranet to invest Rs 5 billion in broadband infrastructure

The Shyam Group-promoted Spectranet plans to infuse Rs 5 billion to increase its broadband infrastructure and number of retail subscribers and create hotspots in India. The investment will be made over the next five years. The Internet services provider is likely to raise money from bank loans, internal accruals and offloading up to 26 per cent stake to private equity investors.

ei labz to impart training on Wind River RTOS

Everest Infocom, also known as ei labz, will be authorised training centre for Wind River's flagship RTOS Vxworks 6.x and Workbench, Wind River Linux and Workbench, and Real-time Programming for Embedded System. RTOS are integral part of embedded systems ranging from small network routers to high-end, mission-critical defence systems in apache helicopters.

Nokia-Siemens to hire 800 more

Nokia-Siemens is planning to hire around 800 more people this year at its Global Network Service Centre (GNSC) located in Chennai. "Currently, the headcount in our GNSC in Chennai is around 1000 and this will be increased to 1800 by the end of this year. This centre was set up in 2007 with an employee strength of 120," informed Armando Almedia, head of Global Services, Nokia-Siemens.

of their IT so they can simplify day-to-day tasks, increase productivity and focus on innovation. With the launch of these printers in India, we are excited to add one more dimension to our portfolio and offer more comprehensive solutions to our customers."

Haier India goes green

Home appliances and consumer electronics company Haier has announced its green initiative 'Eco Life' in India as part of its global rebranding exercise aimed at designing smart products that not only meet customers' needs but also adhere to environmental norms. Its latest eco-friendly offerings include a wide range of LCD and LED TVs.

Haier India has also announced its entry into three new product categories, viz, laptops, home theatres and cameras. With these new initiatives, it is targeting a turnover of over Rs 17 billion this year as against Rs 8.25 billion achieved last year.

Canon to sell Océ products

Canon India, a technology provider in the printing domain, and Océ, a digital document management and delivery solutions provider, will join forces with an aim to become No. 1 in the professional and graphics printing industry in India. Océ is headquartered in the Netherlands.

Canon will sell, distribute and service Océ products in the areas of production printing, wide-format printing, signage printing and business services. Currently, it holds about 90 per cent stake in Océ.

NXP labs at top engineering institutes

NXP Semiconductors has announced an industry-academia initiative called 'Anubhav' to establish labs at top engineering institutes in India. Kicking off the initiative, Dr René Penning de Vries, senior vice president and chief

technology officer, NXP Semiconductors, and Neeraj Paliwal, vice president and NXP India managing director and design services global manager, central R&D, inaugurated the NXP labs at three institutes in Bengaluru - BMS College of Engineering, PES Institute of Technology and RV College of Engineering.

Said Paliwal, "We plan to set up approximately 20 such labs across India by the end of 2011 and be actively involved in partnering with them to bring industry knowledge into academia."

DRDO plans centre at IIT Madras

The Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO) recently signed a contract to establish a research and innovation centre in the Research Park of the Indian Institute of Technology (IIT), Madras.

Dr V.K. Saraswat, director general, DRDO, revealed that the new project would encourage a free flow of scientists, academicians and students and focus on materials manufacturing, aerospace, software development and nano materials.

DRDO scientists will work at the IIT as adjunct professors. Similarly, IIT professors and students will work as scientists at DRDO.

HCL to sell HCL Infinet to Tikona

HCL is selling the entire stake of its subsidiary HCL Infinet to Tikona Digital Networks. The move is part of HCL Infosystems' transformation strategy under which the company will beef up its core business and expand into identified growth areas.

In another development, HCL Infosystems has bagged a project to set up ICT (information and communication technology) labs at 628 government-run schools in the state of Himachal Pradesh. Following this, it will also train 6500 teachers on the usage of multimedia educational content.